

by creating a vibrant iOS developer community, and a centralized, curated repository of applications that spanned across almost all categories. Apple called this repository the “App Store,” which presently hosts more than 6,50,000 applications.

Apple requires all apps on the App Store to follow a certain set of guidelines. These guidelines include the obvious “your app can’t steal private data,” “install backdoors into the user’s device” and other similar security measures. But these guidelines also include clauses that prevent certain kinds of applications to appear on the App Store at all. Apps that customize the look of iOS, replicate functionality provided by Apple, allow command line access to the OS, provide ways to tweak the system are all disallowed into the App Store which means that users don’t get access to these apps.

Well, most of them anyway. While Apple’s controlled ecosystem works really well for most average users, power users find this to be a dealbreaker. Fortunately, there’s a way for these power users to work around Apple’s restrictions and gain complete access into their devices to do absolutely whatever they want. This is established by a method called “jailbreaking.”

Jailbreaking dates back to the introduction of the first generation iPhone. Back then, the App Store didn’t even exist and the only apps that you could run on your iPhone were the ones that shipped with it. Hackers found ways to get access to the operating system and allow the installation of third party apps, providing a glimpse into the future of the iOS ecosystem.

Technically, jailbreak software exploits certain holes in iOS to gain “root” access into the system. Once “root” access is established, the OS is opened up and there are no restrictions at all.

Jailbreaking also has a closely related process, unlocking. Apple generally partners with carriers to sell the iPhone, and in many cases the device is locked to the carrier’s network. Unlocking, as the names suggests, lets the iPhone run on any carrier’s network as long as the carrier’s bands are supported by the hardware.

So let’s dive in, and help you unlock the full potential of your iPhone!

Jailbreaking, although meant for power users, is a really easy process. The tools required for jailbreaking are easy to use and pretty quick. They vary depending on the version of iOS that your phone runs though. Some jailbreak tools even require you to connect your iPhone to your PC/Mac every time you boot up. These are called “tethered” jailbreaks, and as you can imagine, introduce a bit of difficulty when you’re away from your computers for a few days.